

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Law and the legal system • Psychology • Sociology • Languages • Physical education • Counseling and helping people



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS There are no formal requirements, but you will need a reasonable school education and be able to pass a series of aptitude tests.



LIFESTYLE Corrections officers are usually expected to work shifts, including nights, weekends, and public holidays.



LOCATION Corrections officers are based in the prison, supervising inmates indoors, during outdoor activities in prison yards, and on outings and transfers.



THE REALITIES Work conditions can be stressful. They may have to deal with inmates who are prone to aggression, and may need to resolve inmates' disputes.



SERGEANT Supervises a small team of other officers or takes responsibility for one wing (area) of the prison. As well as making sure corrections officers carry out their duties, senior officers must undertake administrative work in the prison office. This role is a promotion, following several years' experience and some further training.



PRISON WARDEN Manages a prison and takes responsibility for controlling budgets and other resources, supervising junior officers, and liaising with social workers and other agencies involved in the rehabilitation and welfare of inmates.

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication and mediation skills to help defuse potentially volatile situations.



Strong team-working skills to work alongside other personnel to control and safeguard inmates.



The ability to stay calm and remain patient despite stressful and challenging circumstances.



Strength and endurance for dealing quickly and efficiently with displays of aggression from inmates.



Strong powers of observation to detect any unusual activities and behaviors in the prison.

In 2012, more than 465,000 corrections officers were employed in the United States.